PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Miebaka Portfolio

A proof-led structural upgrade that preserves the restored visual character

DOCUMENT	VALUE
Owner	Miebaka Joshua
Status	Implementation-ready PRD
Product	miebaka.design portfolio
Visual authority	Restored production baseline — commit 54dcc41
Source	Portfolio Design Engineering Review and implementation plan
Date	13 October 2026

PRODUCT DECISION

Improve structure, proof, accessibility and conversion without redesigning the site's visual identity. The restored production website is the visual source of truth; the proof-sheet contributes selective editorial mechanisms, not a replacement skin.

1. Executive summary

The portfolio already has a distinctive visual voice: editorial restraint, an Ultramarine–paper–ink palette, sharp geometry, authored imagery, quiet motion, a strong portrait treatment and warm, direct writing. Its primary weakness is not visual taste; it is insufficient proof. Hiring managers and potential clients can see an authored surface, but cannot consistently reach complete case studies, evaluate the work, submit a reliable enquiry or understand the full range of practice.

This release turns the current site into a credible senior-design portfolio by making the proof layer complete and trustworthy. It opens one flagship case study first, restructures the homepage around evidence, adds truthful Explorations and Community destinations, strengthens the Index, ships a real contact service, makes the CV accessible, and introduces robust accessibility, performance and content-governance requirements.

The release must feel like the same website, only more resolved. No requirement authorizes a stylistic reset. Proof-sheet ideas may be used only where they clarify production, sequencing or authorship and remain subordinate to the restored visual system.

2. Product vision and positioning

2.1 Vision

Create a precise, memorable portfolio that lets design leaders quickly understand Miebaka's point of view, inspect the quality of his decisions and production thinking, and confidently begin a conversation.

2.2 Positioning

Miebaka is presented as a senior multidisciplinary designer whose value lies in the connection between strategic thinking, visual systems, editorial judgment and production discipline—not as a generalist offering an undifferentiated list of services.

2.3 Primary product job

Help hiring managers and design leaders evaluate Miebaka for senior design employment. Client enquiries and professional reputation are important secondary jobs.

2.4 Target roles and markets

- Primary roles: Art Director, Senior Brand Designer and Senior Visual Designer.
- Markets: remote international roles, Nigerian roles and relocation opportunities.
- Secondary opportunities: selected identity, campaign, editorial and creative-direction engagements.

3. Objectives and success definition

PRIORITY	OBJECTIVE	SUCCESS SIGNAL
P0	Make professional work evaluable	At least the TEDx RSU flagship case study is public, complete and navigable.
P0	Make contact reliable	The form sends through a server endpoint, reports clear states and preserves input after recoverable failure.
P0	Preserve exact visual character	Owner review confirms continuity with the restored baseline; no proof-sheet or generic UI drift.
P1	Clarify the breadth of practice	Work, Explorations, Community, About, Services and Writing have truthful destinations and states.
P1	Strengthen professional trust	CV, verified metadata, clear roles and factual case-study captions are available.
P1	Improve inclusive quality	Keyboard, reduced-motion, no-JS, 320px, zoom and assistive-technology release checks pass.

PRIORITY	OBJECTIVE	SUCCESS SIGNAL
P1	Protect speed and stability	Core Web Vitals and bundle budgets meet the release gates in this PRD.

3.1 Conversion hierarchy

- Primary conversion: send a credible contact enquiry.
- Secondary conversions: complete a case study, download the CV, visit LinkedIn, remember the work and return.
- Micro-conversions: open the Index, inspect services, view project metadata and continue to the next project.

4. Users and priority journeys

AUDIENCE	NEED	REQUIRED JOURNEY
Design leader / hiring manager	Fast evidence of senior judgment, role clarity and craft	Home → selected work → TEDx RSU → About/CV → Contact
Founder / client	Confidence in fit, process and delivery	Home → Services → relevant project → Contact
Creative director / collaborator	A clear view of authorship and complementary strengths	Index → Work/Explorations → project detail → Contact
General visitor	A legible introduction without specialist knowledge	Home → selected work/profile → Index
Designer / peer	Process, production and editorial detail	Work → project plates/captions → Writing

4.1 Journey requirements

- Every route must make the next meaningful action clear without adding loud, conversion-template styling.
- The visitor must never encounter a locked professional project without a truthful explanation and an available published alternative.
- The full site must remain understandable with JavaScript disabled; enhancements may enrich, not reveal, core content.

5. Current-state problem statement

PROBLEM	IMPACT	PRIORITY
All professional case studies are locked	The site asks for trust without supplying enough evidence.	P0
Homepage biography precedes proof	The strongest hiring-manager journey is delayed.	P0
Explorations and Community are missing	The navigation cannot truthfully represent the full practice.	P1
Contact is mailto-only and the API route fails	Primary conversion is unreliable and hard to measure.	P0
Tests protect an obsolete contract	Green checks can validate the wrong product behavior.	P0
Navigation and CV access are incomplete	Users must infer routes and professional history.	P1
Client loop lacks a visible pause control	Motion is not fully operable or inclusive.	P1

PROBLEM	IMPACT	PRIORITY
Content, CSS and JavaScript are overly consolidated	Changes carry avoidable regression and maintenance risk.	P1
Some claims lack evidence	Professional trust can be weakened by unsupported outcomes.	P0

6. Product and design principles

- Preserve before extending. The restored production site at commit 54dcc41 is the visual authority.
- Proof before biography. Show the work early, then deepen the human story.
- Truth over completeness. A candid coming-soon or empty state is better than invented work, metrics or testimony.
- One visual argument. New UI must belong to the existing editorial system, not introduce cards, pills or dashboard conventions.
- Mechanism must reveal meaning. Expressive interactions are allowed only when they reveal process, material, sequencing or authorship.
- Content before animation. Essential content, actions and navigation must exist in the document before enhancement runs.
- Quiet confidence. Motion, labels and controls should feel precise and deliberate rather than theatrical.

6.1 Immutable visual characteristics

- Ultramarine, paper and ink remain the governing neutral/accent relationship; authored project colours remain project-specific.
- Retain the current typography hierarchy and three-typeface ceiling.
- Retain low density, sharp geometry, asymmetric air, quiet motion, portrait treatment and signature/footer character.
- Do not replace the site with the proof-sheet interface, Material 3, a generic portfolio template or a component-library aesthetic.

7. Scope

7.1 In scope

- Reordered homepage with selected work before profile, followed by services, client proof and contact.
- Mixed publication states for projects, with one complete flagship case study at launch.
- New Explorations and Community destinations with supplied entries or truthful empty states.
- Expanded full-screen editorial Index containing all routes, contact, CV and preference controls.
- Downloadable CV linked from About and Index.
- Five-service swatch interaction, experience ledger and controlled client-logo loop.
- Server-backed contact form, updated privacy content, structured error handling and abuse protection.
- Content-model split, build-time validation, CSS/JS consolidation and production-output cleanup.
- Accessibility, performance, browser, security and visual-regression release gates.

7.2 Explicit non-goals

- Recreating the rejected thesis-aligned redesign or replacing the current visual language.
- Publishing incomplete projects as finished work or inventing outcomes, testimonials, communities or principles.
- Adding authentication, a database, a CMS, advertising trackers or a large analytics stack.
- Making every proof-sheet motif global, adopting a fourth typeface, a custom cursor or mandatory smooth-scroll libraries.
- Deploying material visual changes without preview review and explicit owner approval.

8. Information architecture

ROUTE	PURPOSE	LAUNCH STATE
Home	Positioning, selected proof, profile, services, trust and contact	Required

ROUTE	PURPOSE	LAUNCH STATE
Work	Published and forthcoming professional projects	Required
Work / TEDx RSU	Flagship end-to-end case study	Required
Explorations	Self-initiated, experimental or process-led work	Required; truthful empty state allowed
Community	Community activity, contribution and convening	Required; truthful empty state allowed
About	Biography, experience, capabilities and CV access	Required
Services	Five clear service offers and engagement fit	Required
Writing	Existing essays and future authored thinking	Retain
Contact	Direct email and reliable form submission	Required
Privacy	Contact-data and site-privacy disclosure	Footer only

8.1 Navigation model

- Keep the desktop navigation persistent and visually quiet.
- Use the Index as the comprehensive navigation layer; it must include every route, contact details, CV and theme/motion preferences.
- Do not introduce a bottom navigation bar unless testing demonstrates a clear benefit without compromising the visual character.

9. Functional requirements by surface

9.1 Homepage

ORDER	MODULE	REQUIREMENT
1	Hero	Retain the restored composition and positioning. Add a support line only if it does not weaken the hierarchy.
2	Selected work	Show published work first. Cards/links must disclose publication state and be keyboard-operable.
3	Profile / portrait	Retain the quiet photographic treatment; do not restore the retired halftone portrait.
4	Services	Show five offers through the swatch mechanism, with all content available without motion.
5	Client proof	Use factual client marks/names; the loop must have visible pause/play and become static under reduced motion.
6	Working principles	Include only after owner-supplied copy is approved; omit rather than invent.
7	Contact	Provide direct email plus the server-backed form and clear response states.
8	Signature/footer	Preserve the restored signature and footer character.

9.2 Work index

- Support published, coming-soon and private/archive states through explicit metadata.
- Published projects open directly. Coming-soon projects remain visible only when their presence adds useful context and their state is unambiguous.
- Do not lock every project. A visitor must always have a complete published case study to evaluate.

9.3 Flagship case study: TEDx RSU

- Open with a concise proposition and a strong hero asset.
- State role, collaborators, year and deliverables close to the opening.
- Tell the sequence: context → problem → relevant process → strategic decision → system → applications → production/handoff → verified outcomes → reflection → next project.
- Show only process that survived into or materially informed the final direction; do not pad the page with rejected routes.
- Use proof-sheet mechanisms selectively: PLATE numbering, factual captions, a restrained chapter/folio system and production details.
- Omit metrics or outcomes that cannot be evidenced. Clearly distinguish individual contribution from team contribution.

9.4 Explorations and Community

- Each route must exist at launch and explain its purpose in plain language.
- If approved entries are unavailable, show an intentional empty state with no fabricated dates, scale, partners or outcomes.
- Empty-state pages must still include global navigation, Index access and a relevant next action.

9.5 About, CV and experience

- Present biography, capabilities and experience without duplicating the homepage word-for-word.
- Use an experience ledger for role, organisation, period and concise contribution; treat it as evidence, not decoration.
- Offer an approved, accessible PDF CV from About and Index. The CV is not a primary top-level route.

9.6 Services

- Present five discrete offers with clear problems solved, typical outputs and engagement fit.
- Desktop may use a layered swatch fan; mobile must use an accessible horizontal or stacked presentation with no hidden content.
- Selection, focus and expanded state must be perceivable without relying on colour or hover alone.

9.7 Contact

- Require name, valid email and message; apply documented field and request limits.
- Show idle, focused, validating, submitting, success, rate-limited, unavailable and recoverable-error states.
- Preserve entered values when submission fails. Never clear the form before confirmed success.
- Always show a copyable email address and a truthful no-JavaScript fallback.

10. Content and evidence requirements

CONTENT TYPE	RULE	OWNER DEPENDENCY
Project claims	Publish only verified outcomes, dates, roles and collaborators.	Approved facts and sources
Project media	Provide final, rights-cleared assets with dimensions, alt intent and captions.	TEDx RSU media package
Explorations	Use real self-initiated work or a truthful empty state.	Approved entries
Community	Use documented participation/contribution or a truthful empty state.	Approved entries
Working principles	Do not infer principles from tone or prior copy.	Owner-written/approved copy

CONTENT TYPE	RULE	OWNER DEPENDENCY
CV	Use a current, approved and accessible PDF.	Final resume file
Client proof	Use authorised names/marks; do not imply unverified endorsement.	Approved client list/assets

10.1 Content governance

- Every project record must have a unique slug, publication state, route owner, required metadata and valid next-project reference.
- Every media item must declare dimensions, purpose, accessible alternative and loading priority.
- A build-time validator must fail on duplicate slugs, invalid routes, contradictory publication states, missing required metadata and broken project relationships.
- Editorial language must remain warm, precise and direct. Avoid inflated strategic language, generic design clichés and unsupported numerical claims.

11. Interaction, motion and preferences

- Motion must explain hierarchy, continuity, state or production logic; decorative motion without a communicative job is out of scope.
- The Index, service swatches and project transitions must remain fully usable by keyboard and touch.
- Reduced-motion behavior must be designed per component: replace loops and large transforms with static or low-motion alternatives rather than applying a blanket 1ms override.
- Theme and motion preferences must persist without blocking first render or exposing a flash that materially changes the intended composition.
- Avoid mandatory GSAP, Lenis, ScrollTrigger or SplitText dependencies. Add a library only after the native implementation proves insufficient and the budget still passes.
- Do not use a custom cursor, hover-only instructions, cloned semantic text or live decorative feeds that fail silently.

12. Accessibility requirements

WCAG 2.2 AA is the release floor. The product should retain stronger contrast where it already exists, but must not impose a universal 7:1 target when that would damage the approved visual character without meaningful benefit.

AREA	REQUIREMENT
Keyboard	All routes, controls, overlays, swatches, project links and form states are reachable, visible and operable.
Focus	Focus treatment is obvious against every theme and project colour; focus is managed when Index/overlays open and close.
Touch	Interactive hit regions target approximately 44×44 CSS pixels where practical.
Motion	Pause is available for moving content; reduced-motion alternatives are component-specific and meaningful.
Forms	Labels, descriptions, required state and errors are programmatically associated and announced.
Structure	Landmarks, heading order, link purpose and current-page state remain coherent across routes.
Resilience	Core content and navigation work without JavaScript; verify forced colours, 200% zoom, increased text spacing and 320px width.
Media	Alt text communicates purpose; decorative assets are ignored; captions carry factual context rather than repeating the image.

13. Performance and compatibility

METRIC	TARGET	HARD GATE
Largest Contentful Paint	≤ 2.0 s	≤ 2.5 s
Interaction to Next Paint	≤ 150 ms	≤ 200 ms
Cumulative Layout Shift	≤ 0.05	≤ 0.05
Initial compressed JavaScript	≤ 60 KB	≤ 75 KB
Initial compressed CSS	≤ 35 KB	≤ 45 KB
Homepage media before interaction	≤ 1.2 MB	≤ 1.5 MB
Navigation long task	None over 100 ms	None over 200 ms

- Prerender essential copy, navigation and project metadata. Defer non-essential media and enhancements.
- Use responsive images, explicit dimensions and appropriate modern formats while preserving authored crops.
- Apply immutable caching only to content-hashed assets. Do not cache mutable HTML as immutable.
- Respect Save-Data and reduced-motion preferences with quieter media and fewer background requests.
- Support the latest two stable versions of Chrome, Safari, Firefox and Edge, plus current iOS Safari and Android Chrome.

14. Technical architecture

14.1 Content model

Split the current monolithic site data into explicit domains: site configuration, navigation, projects, case studies, services, writing and clients. Keep rendered content as the canonical accessible layer; JavaScript manages enhancement and state rather than becoming the only source of content.

14.2 Frontend boundaries

- Create stable modules for navigation/Index, theme, motion preferences, project states, service interaction, marquee control and form state.
- Consolidate duplicated CSS into tokens and component-level rules while preserving measured geometry and visual output.
- Keep route metadata, canonical URLs, social cards and structured data aligned with publication state.
- Treat existing tests as evidence, not authority. Rewrite assertions that encode obsolete locked-project or contact behavior.

14.3 Contact service

Required flow: HTTP handler → request validator → abuse guard → mail-service interface → Resend adapter → structured response and privacy-safe logger.

LAYER	REQUIREMENT
Request	Same-origin JSON POST; require name/email/message; enforce field/body limits; reject unknown/malformed input.
Abuse controls	Honeypot, minimum-fill-time check and shared infrastructure-backed rate limiting—not process memory.
Provider	Resend behind a replaceable interface with an 8-second timeout and mapped provider errors.
Responses	200/202 success; 400/422 validation; 429 with Retry-After; 503 provider unavailable; 500 unexpected.
Logging	Record request ID, status, latency and provider error class; never log message bodies or full email addresses.

LAYER	REQUIREMENT
Client	Maintain values on failure, prevent duplicate submission and provide a direct email fallback.

15. Security and privacy

- Preserve and verify existing security headers. Introduce CSP changes in report-only mode before enforcement.
- Use Vercel as the canonical runtime and document required environment variables without committing secrets.
- Restrict and document any public third-party key. If Last.fm remains, consider a proxy/cache and ensure the portfolio still works when the feed fails.
- Ship production-only output: no source maps, internal drafts, private notes, test fixtures or unused raw assets.
- Do not add advertising trackers. If measurement is introduced, minimise collection and update the privacy page before release.
- Update privacy content to explain contact submissions, retention, processors and a clear deletion/contact route.

16. Measurement plan

V1 success is judged primarily through product completeness, quality gates and direct conversion reliability. A new analytics platform is not required for launch. If privacy-conscious analytics already exists or is later approved, measure only events needed to improve the priority journeys.

SIGNAL	DEFINITION	USE
Case-study completion	Visitor reaches the next-project/reflection region of TEDx RSU	Assess whether proof is being consumed
Contact success rate	Accepted submissions divided by valid attempts	Monitor conversion reliability
Contact error classes	Validation, rate-limit, provider and unexpected failures	Identify operational defects without storing message content
CV downloads	Approved CV download action	Assess professional-intent pathway
Index usage	Open and route selection	Assess wayfinding
Core Web Vitals	Field and controlled-test LCP/INP/CLS	Protect perceived quality

17. Dependencies and owner-supplied inputs

DEPENDENCY	NEEDED FOR	FALLBACK
TEDx RSU assets and verified facts	Flagship case study	Do not publish incomplete or speculative content
Explorations entries	Explorations route	Approved truthful empty state
Community entries	Community route	Approved truthful empty state
Current accessible CV PDF	About and Index	Hide download action until supplied
Verified metrics/collaborators	Project evidence	Omit the claim or collaborator
Working-principles copy	Optional homepage module	Omit the module
Vercel and Resend configuration	Contact delivery	Direct email remains visible; form cannot ship as complete

DEPENDENCY	NEEDED FOR	FALLBACK
Shared rate-limit provider	Abuse prevention	Do not substitute in-memory production limits
Owner preview approval	Production release	Hold deployment

18. Risks and mitigations

RISK	MITIGATION	RELEASE CONSEQUENCE
Visual drift toward the proof sheet or rejected build	Compare every changed route with the restored baseline; require owner visual approval.	Block release
Scope expands into a redesign	Use the in-scope/non-goal boundary and prioritise proof, routes and reliability.	Defer nonessential concepts
Missing content encourages invention	Use explicit content dependencies and truthful empty/omitted states.	Ship less, never fabricate
Animation causes accessibility or performance regressions	Progressive enhancement, per-component reduced motion and budget tests.	Remove or simplify motion
Contact provider or abuse controls fail	Adapter boundary, timeout, structured errors, shared limit and fallback email.	Block form-complete claim
Tests validate old behavior	Rewrite contract tests before feature implementation; add route and state coverage.	Block release
Heavy media undermines perceived quality	Responsive media pipeline, explicit dimensions, preload only the real LCP asset.	Optimise or defer assets

19. Delivery plan

PHASE	OUTCOME	EXIT CRITERION
0 — Protect baseline	Snapshot visual/technical state; rewrite obsolete expectations	Baseline review set and current contract documented
1 — Model and IA	Split content domains; add route/publication schema and validator	Build fails correctly on invalid content
2 — Home and navigation	Proof-first homepage, strengthened Index and truthful project states	All primary routes reachable and keyboard-operable
3 — Flagship proof	Complete TEDx RSU case study	Content, media, captions and claims approved
4 — Professional evidence	About, experience ledger, services and CV	No unsupported claims; CV works
5 — Contact and privacy	Server contact, form states, abuse controls and privacy update	End-to-end delivery and failure tests pass
6 — System consolidation	CSS/JS boundaries, motion and responsive behavior	No visual regression against baseline
7 — Release QA	Accessibility, performance, security, browser and no-JS checks	All hard gates pass
8 — Preview and release	Owner-reviewed preview and production deployment	Explicit owner approval and post-deploy smoke test

20. Acceptance criteria and release gates

20.1 Product completeness

- TEDx RSU is public, complete and reachable from Home and Work.
- Every project link has a truthful destination or explicit state; no false locks or dead-end cards.
- Explorations, Community, About, Services, Writing, Contact and Privacy resolve without broken assets.
- CV download works from About and Index when the approved file is supplied.
- The contact form delivers through the endpoint and correctly handles validation, duplicate, rate-limit, provider and unexpected failures.

20.2 Quality gates

- Owner approves the preview as visually continuous with the restored production baseline.
- No unsupported metrics, project outcomes, client relationships or collaborator credits remain.
- Keyboard, focus, screen-reader basics, reduced motion, forced colours, 200% zoom, increased spacing and 320px tests pass.
- Core navigation, project content and contact fallback work without JavaScript.
- Performance budgets and hard Core Web Vitals gates pass on representative mobile and desktop profiles.
- No console errors, broken links, accidental horizontal overflow, missing metadata or invalid structured data remain.
- Security headers, CSP reporting, production bundle contents and privacy language are verified.
- Latest-two desktop browser matrix and current mobile Safari/Chrome smoke tests pass.

20.3 Release authority

A technically green build is not sufficient approval. Production deployment requires an approved preview, explicit confirmation that the visual character has been preserved, and completion of all P0 requirements and hard release gates.

21. Decision log

DECISION	RATIONALE	STATUS
Restored production site is visual authority	It represents the intentional character the owner chose after reverting the previous build.	Locked
Thesis is supporting, not visually overriding	It supplies requirements and principles but cannot supersede the approved visual baseline.	Locked
Proof sheet contributes mechanisms, not a skin	Its production language is useful selectively; its single-page/locked architecture is not.	Locked
TEDx RSU launches first	One complete flagship case study creates more trust than several partial projects.	Approved direction
CV lives in About and Index	It supports professional evaluation without becoming primary navigation clutter.	Approved direction
No database/CMS/large analytics stack in V1	The release should solve proof and conversion with minimal operational weight.	Locked

22. Open inputs—not open product questions

The product direction is sufficiently defined to begin. The remaining items are content or operational inputs, not requests to reconsider the site's visual identity or architecture.

- Final TEDx RSU media, captions, individual role, collaborators, dates and verifiable outcomes.
- Approved Explorations and Community entries, or approval of the drafted truthful empty states.
- Current CV PDF and confirmation of the five service descriptions.
- Working-principles copy if that optional homepage module is to ship.

- Vercel environment ownership, Resend sender/domain setup and shared rate-limit service choice.
- Final preview approval after the defined browser, accessibility and performance evidence is attached.

23. Definition of done

The release is done when a first-time design leader can arrive on the homepage, understand the positioning, inspect a complete and truthful flagship case study, verify relevant experience, obtain the CV and send a reliable enquiry—on keyboard, touch, reduced-motion and no-JavaScript paths—without encountering a broken route, unsupported claim or visual departure from the restored site.